

Make your own!

Small Tortoiseshell Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Orange, black & dark-brown felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The green felt mat for meadow habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
 - 2 Cut out all 9 pieces carefully.
 - 3 Lay the green mat down — that's your meadow!
 - 4 Place the 2 hindwings, then 2 forewings on top.
 - 5 Lay the body down the centre, over the wings.
 - 6 Add a marking to each forewing and 2 antennae.
- Done!

Did you know?



One of Britain's most common, colourful butterflies.

Adults hibernate over winter, often in sheds.

Its caterpillars eat only stinging nettles.

It basks with wings open to warm up in the sun.

The blue crescents on the wing edge warn off birds.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper



Orange · Black · Dark brown

Using the template, cut out:

Forewings ×2 — orange (one mirrored)

Hindwings ×2 — orange (one mirrored)

Markings ×2 — black

Body ×1 — dark brown

Antennae ×2 — dark brown

That's 9 shapes in total!

Optional: white wingtip dots & blue edge dots.

Finished!



Your butterfly is about 13 × 9 cm.

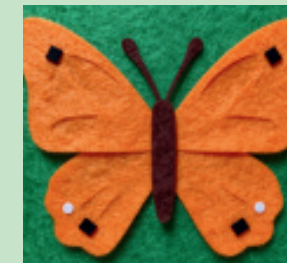
Take it apart and build it again!

Forewings over hindwings, body down the centre.

Collect the set:

Meadow: butterfly, ladybird, grasshopper

Make your own



Small

Tortoiseshell
Aglais urticae

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

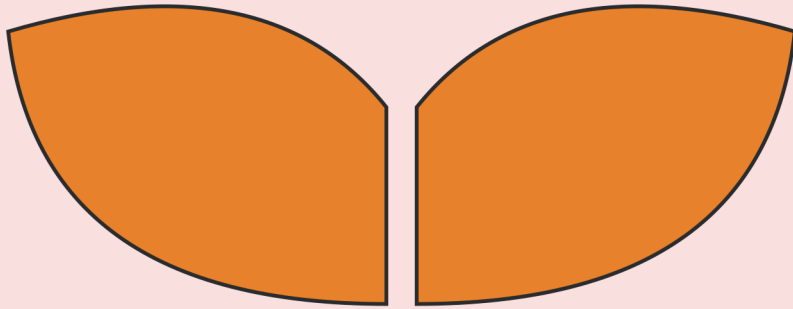


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

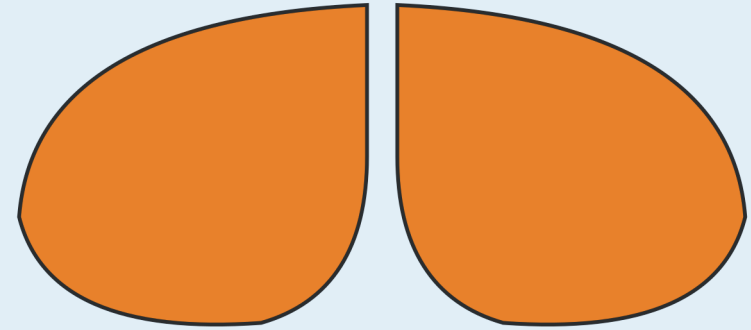
Photo © newright, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

Forewings x2



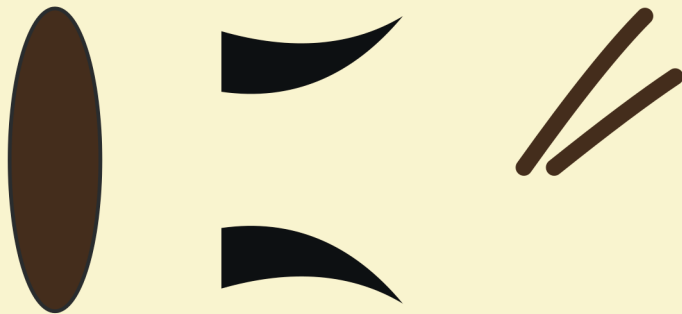
Orange felt · cut 2 forewings
The big upper wings (one mirrored)

Hindwings x2



Orange felt · cut 2 hindwings
Rounded — sit below the forewings

Body, markings & antennae



1 body + 2 antennae (dark brown) · 2 markings (black)

Finished! ★



This is what it looks like!
About 13 × 9 cm when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

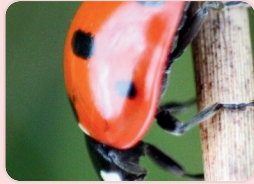
Make your own!

7-spot Ladybird Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Red, black & white felt or paper
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The green felt mat for insect habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 17 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the green mat down — that's your meadow!
- 4 Place the red body, then the black head and antennae.
- 5 Tuck 6 legs under — three each side.
- 6 Dot on the 7 spots. Done!

Did you know?



The 7-spot ladybird is Britain's most common!

It eats hundreds of aphids — gardeners love it.

Bright red warns birds it tastes horrible!

It can ooze yellow matter from its knees!

They hibernate in big groups over winter.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper



Red · Black · White

Using the template, cut out:

- Body ×1 — red
- Head ×1 — black (2 white cheek dots)
- Legs ×6 — black (pointy ends)
- Antennae ×2 — black (round ends)
- Spots ×7 — black (small circles)

That's 17 shapes in total!
Plus 2 white cheek dots (optional).

Finished!



Your ladybird is about 7 × 6 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Move the spots around — every ladybird can be different!

Collect the set:

Meadow: butterfly, ladybird, grasshopper

Make your own



7-spot Ladybird
Coccinella septempunctata

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

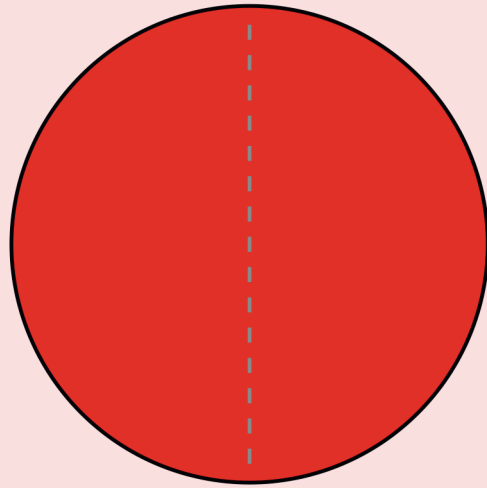


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

Photo © Alfie Felton, CC0
Logo © Giant Insect World

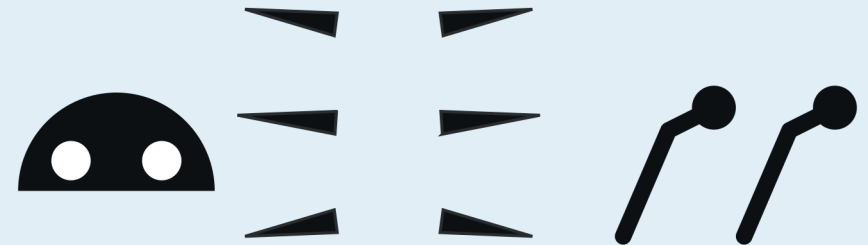
Body x1



Red felt · cut 1

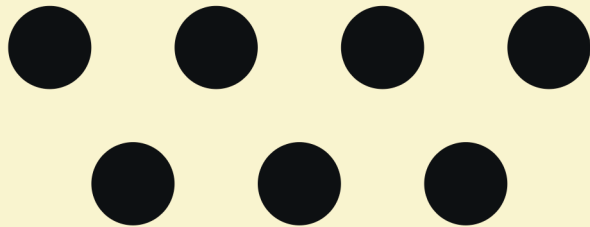
Dashed line = centre (don't cut!)

Head, legs & antennae



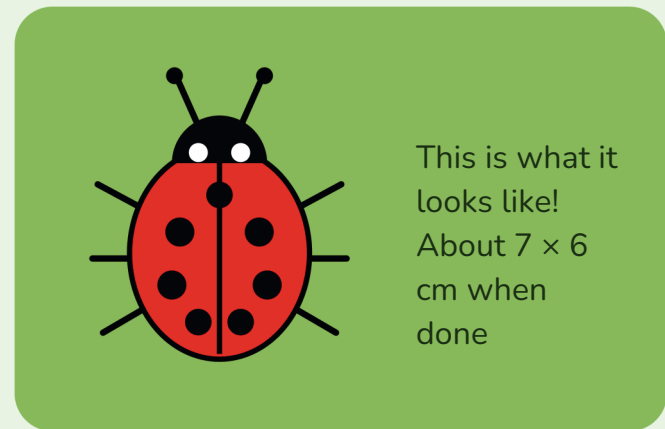
Black felt · cut 1 head + 6 legs + 2 antennae All separate pieces · legs taper to a point

Spots x7



Black felt · cut 7 circles
1 top-centre + 3 on each side

Finished! ★



This is what it looks like!
About 7 × 6 cm when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!



Meadow Grasshopper Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Green, tan & black felt or paper
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The green felt mat for meadow habitat

How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 9 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the green mat down — that's your meadow!
- 4 Place the body, head to the left; wing on its back.
- 5 Add the big hind leg: femur, then thin tibia.
- 6 Add 2 front legs, the eye and 2 antennae. Done!

Did you know?



It "sings" by rubbing its legs against its wings.

Its big back legs can jump 20× its body length.

Its body is green or brown, to hide among the grass.

Listen for its soft "rrr-rrr" on warm summer days.

It eats grass and basks in the sun.

The pieces



Find these colours in felt or paper



Green · Tan · Black

Using the template, cut out:

Body ×1 — green

Wing ×1 — tan

Hind femur ×1 + tibia ×1 — green

Front legs ×2 — green

Eye ×1 — black

Antennae ×2 — green

That's 9 shapes in total!

Finished!



Your grasshopper is about 11 × 6 cm.

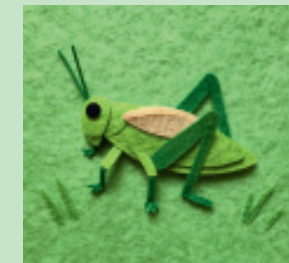
Take it apart and build it again!

Bend the hind leg into a Z — ready to spring!

Collect the set:

Meadow: butterfly, ladybird,
grasshopper

Make your own



Meadow Grasshopper *Pseudochorthippus parallelus*

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

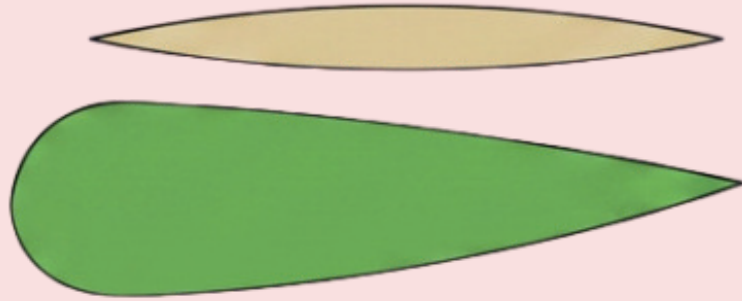


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

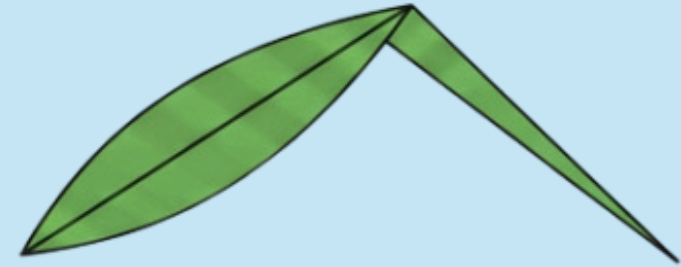
Photo © Susan Marley, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

Body & wing



Green body $\times 1$ + tan wing $\times 1$
Body has the head at the left

Hind leg (2 parts)



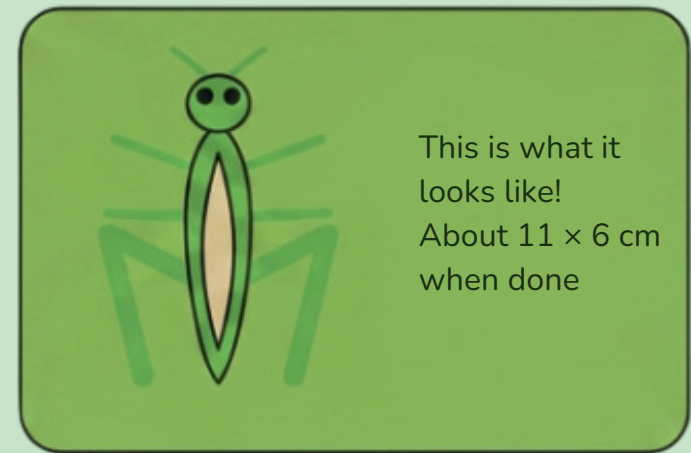
Green felt · 1 hind femur + 1 hind tibia
Two separate pieces — bend into a Z

Front legs, eye & antennae



2 front legs (green) · 1 eye (black) · 2 antennae (green)

Finished! ★



✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!

River Skater Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Pale tan, mid-brown, golden & dark-maroon felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The blue felt mat for pond habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 13 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the blue mat down — that's your pond!
- 4 Place the underbody, then the back on top.
- 5 Add the golden head, 2 eyes and 2 antennae.
- 6 Tuck 6 legs under — splayed out wide. Done!

Did you know?



It skates on the surface film of ponds and rivers.

Water-repellent leg hairs trap air, so it never sinks.

It feels ripples in the water to find food.

The long middle legs row; the back legs steer.

One of Britain's largest pond skaters.

The pieces



Find these colours in felt or paper



Pale tan · Mid brown · Golden · Dark maroon

Using the template, cut out:

Underbody ×1 — pale tan Back

×1 — mid brown

Head ×1 — golden tan

Eyes ×2 — dark maroon

Legs ×6 — mid brown

Antennae ×2 — dark maroon

That's 13 shapes in total!

Finished!



Your river skater is about 11 x 9 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Slender body, legs splayed wide — the middle pair longest.

Collect the set:

Aquatic: river skater, dragonfly, bell spider

Make your own



River skater
Aquarius najas

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

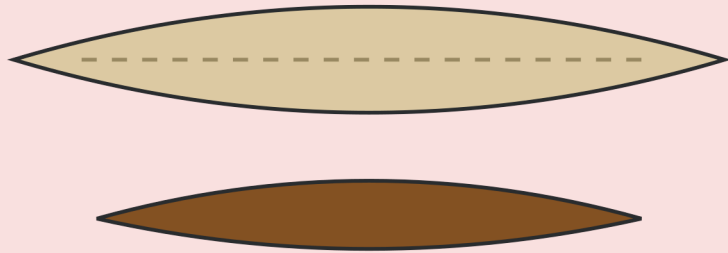


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

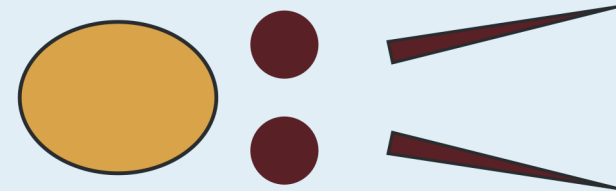
Photo © Alfie Felton, CC0
Logo © Giant Insect World

Underbody & back



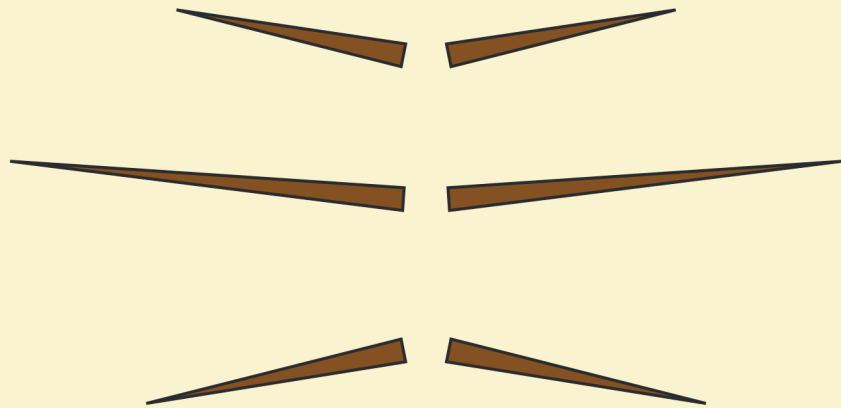
Pale-tan underbody ×1 + mid-brown back
×1 Dashed = centre guide (don't cut)

Head, eyes & antennae



Golden head ×1 · 2 dark-maroon eyes · 2 antennae

Legs ×6



Mid-brown felt · cut 6 legs
2 short front · 2 long middle · 2 hind —
separate

Finished! ★



This is what it
looks like!
About 11 × 9 cm
when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!



Common Darter Dragonfly Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Orange, pale-cream & dark-brown felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The blue felt mat for pond habitat

How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 7 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the blue mat down — that's your pond!
- 4 Place the long orange body down the middle.
- 5 Add 2 wings each side — spread them out wide.
- 6 Add the 2 dark eyes at the top (the head). Done!

Did you know?



One of the last dragonflies still flying in autumn.

Its 4 wings beat separately — it can fly backwards.

Huge eyes see almost all the way around.

A fierce hunter, catching midges in mid-air.

It starts life underwater as a nymph.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper



Orange · Pale cream · Dark brown

Using the template, cut out:

Body ×1 — orange

Wings ×4 — pale cream

Eyes ×2 — dark brown

That's 7 shapes in total!

Finished!



Your dragonfly is about 9 x 8 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Long body down the centre, 4 wings out wide.

Collect the set:

Aquatic: river skater, dragonfly, bell spider

Make your own



Common Darter
Sympetrum striolatum

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

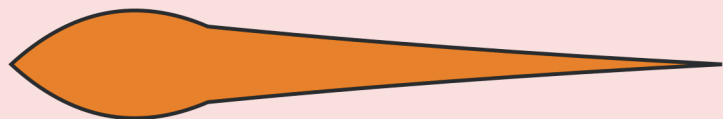


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

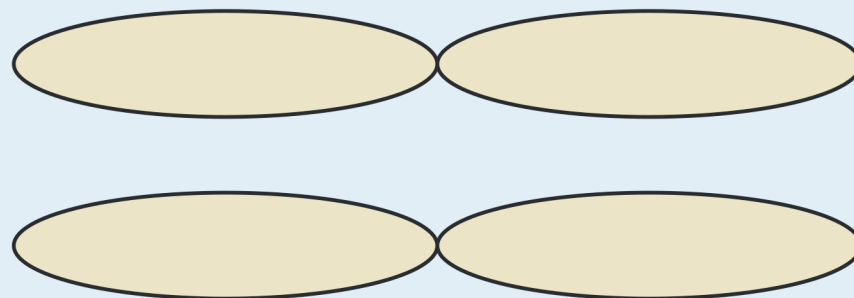
Photo © Sheelagh Halsey, CC-BY
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Body x1



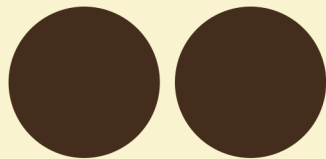
Orange felt · cut 1
Long body — the head end is fatter

Wings x4



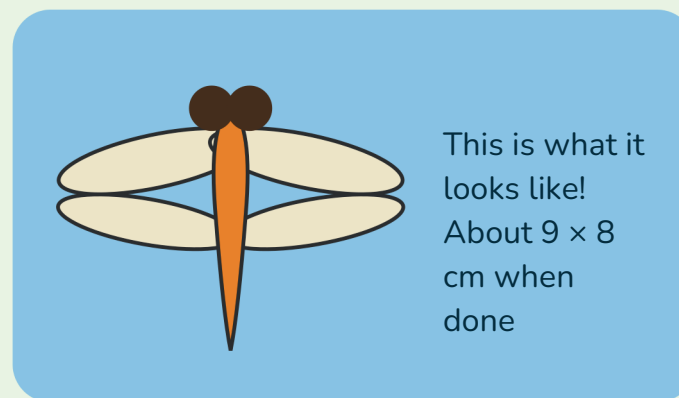
Pale-cream felt · cut 4 wings
Long & narrow — all the same

Eyes x2



Dark-brown felt · cut 2 eyes

Finished! ★



This is what it
looks like!
About 9 × 8
cm when
done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!

Diving Bell Spider Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Dark-brown & pale-silver felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The blue felt mat for pond habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 11 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the blue mat down — that's your pond!
- 4 Place the pale air bubble — its diving bell.
- 5 Round body at top, big abdomen on the bubble.
- 6 Add 8 legs — 4 each side, spread wide. Done!

Did you know?



The only spider that lives its whole life underwater.

It spins a silk "bell" and fills it with air from above.

It breathes the trapped air like a tiny aqualung.

Britain's only underwater spider.

It hunts water insects and tiny pond creatures.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper



Dark brown · Pale silver

Using the template, cut out:

Cephalothorax ×1 — dark brown (front body)

Abdomen ×1 — dark brown (round rear)

Legs ×8 — dark brown

Air bubble ×1 — pale silver

That's 11 shapes in total!



Finished!

Your bell spider is about 8 x 8 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Body sits on its air bubble, 8 legs out wide.

Collect the set:

Aquatic: river skater, dragonfly, bell spider



Make your own



Bell Spider
Argyroneta aquatica

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

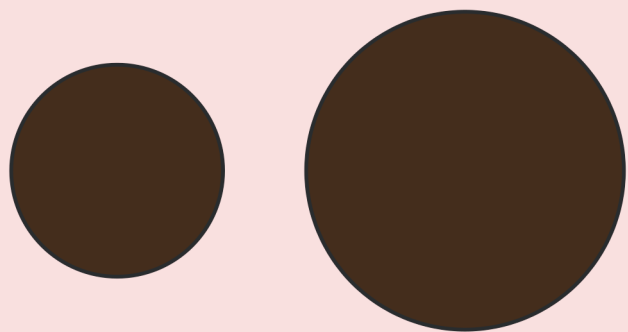


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

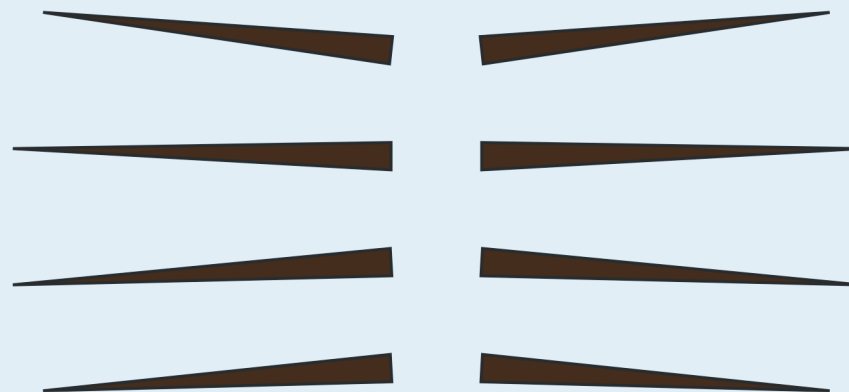
Photo © mark-sundown, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

Body x2



Dark-brown felt · cut 1 cephalothorax + 1 abdomen

Legs x8



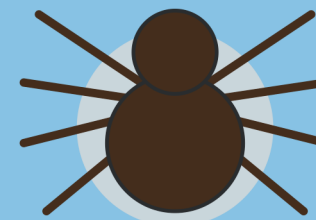
Dark-brown felt · cut 8 legs
Four each side — separate pieces

Air bubble x1



Pale-silver felt · cut 1
Its diving bell — sits behind the
body

Finished! ★



This is what it
looks like!
About 8 × 8
cm when
done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!



Common Shiny Woodlouse Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Grey & dark-grey felt or paper
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The brown felt mat for soil habitat

How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the right felt colour.
- 2 Cut out all 18 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the brown mat down — that's your soil!
- 4 Place the grey body, then add the head at the front.
- 5 Tuck 14 legs under and add 2 antennae.
- 6 The lines show its armour segments. Done!

Did you know?



It's a crustacean - more closely related to crabs!

It breathes through gills and needs damp places.

It recycles rotting leaves, helping make new soil.

Also called a roly-poly, cheeselog or pill bug.

When scared it can roll up into a tiny ball.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper



Grey · Dark grey

Using the template, cut out:

Body ×1 — grey (segmented oval)

Head ×1 — grey

Legs ×14 — dark grey

Antennae ×2 — grey

That's 18 shapes in total!

Finished!



Your woodlouse is about 5 × 3 cm.

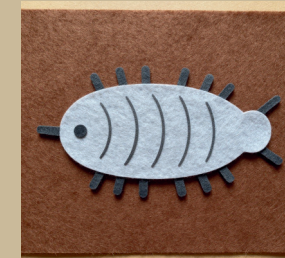
Take it apart and build it again!

Real woodlice can roll into a ball!

Collect the set:

Underground: woodlouse,
earthworm, ant

Make your own



Common Shiny Woodlouse *Oniscus asellus*

A Giant Insect World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart ·
build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

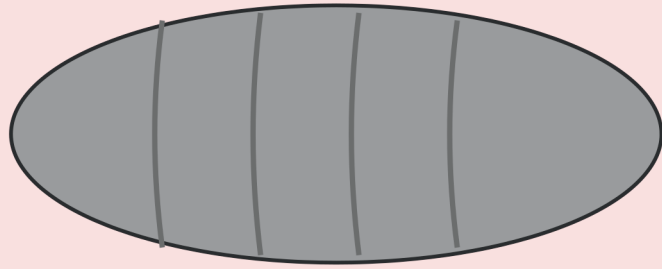


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

Photo © Stuart Fraser, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

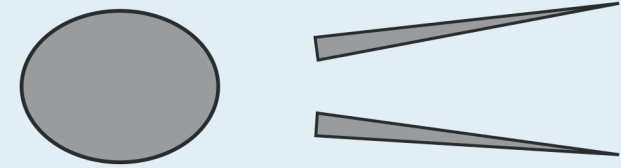
Body x1



Grey felt · cut 1

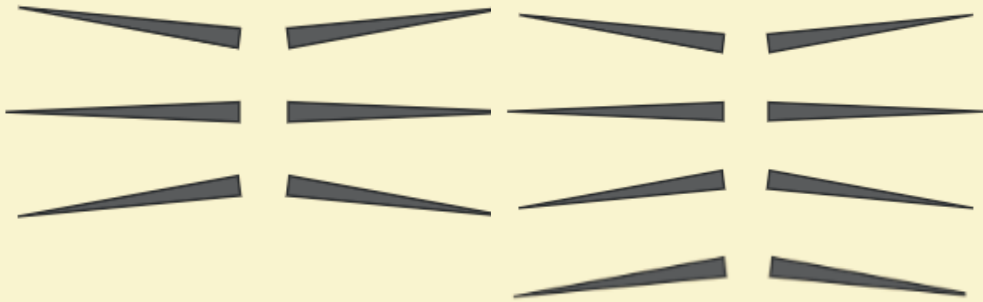
Thin lines = armour segments (don't cut)

Head & antennae



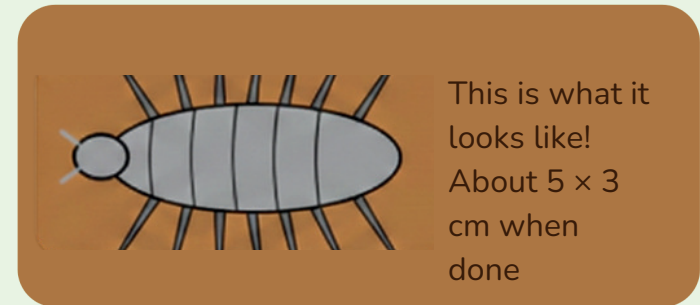
Grey felt · cut 1 head + 2 antennae
Separate pieces

Legs x14



Dark grey felt · cut 14 legs
Seven each side — separate

Finished! ★



This is what it looks like!
About 5 × 3 cm when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!

Common Earthworm Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Reddish-brown & pale-orange felt
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The brown felt mat for soil habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the reddish-brown felt.
- 2 Cut out all 3 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the brown mat down — that's your soil!
- 4 Place the front body, pointed head at the top.
- 5 Add the rear body below; curve them into an S.
- 6 Lay the pale saddle over the join. Done!

Did you know?



No eyes, ears or bones — it breathes through its skin.

It eats its way through soil, recycling dead leaves.

Its tunnels let air and water into the ground.

Charles Darwin studied worms for 39 years!

Tiny bristles grip the soil so it can pull itself along.

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper

Reddish brown · Pale orange



Using the template, cut out:

Front body ×1 — reddish brown

Rear body ×1 — reddish brown

Saddle ×1 — pale orange

That's 3 shapes in total!

The simplest kit in the set — a great first puzzle.

Finished!



Your earthworm is about 12 × 4 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Wiggle it into any shape you like — worms are bendy!

Collect the set:

Underground: woodlouse, earthworm, ant

Make your own



Common Earthworm
Lumbricus terrestris

A Giant Insect
World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart
· build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

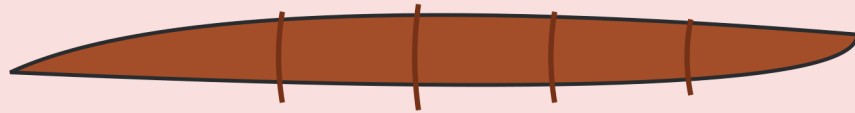


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

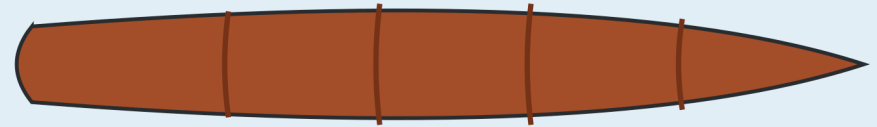
Photo © Daniel
Buczkievicz, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

Front body x1



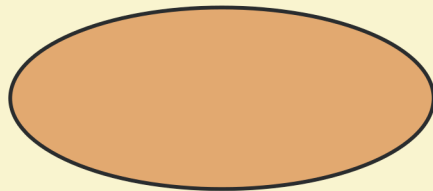
Reddish-brown felt · cut 1
Pointed end = head · lines = segment
rings

Rear body x1



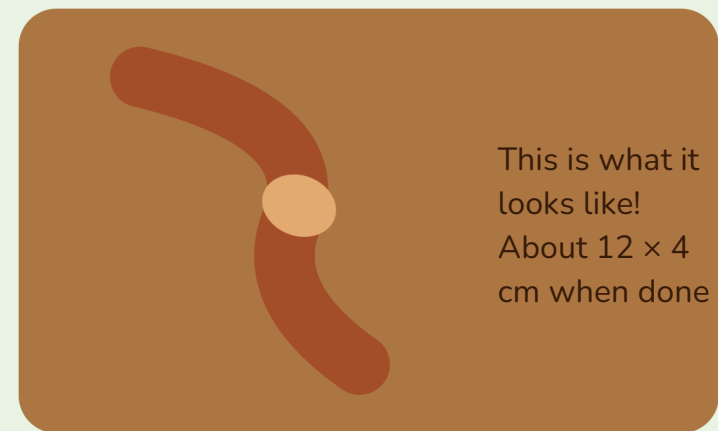
Reddish-brown felt · cut 1
Joins the front body in the
middle

Saddle x1



Pale-orange felt · cut 1
The "saddle" — sits over the
join

Finished! ★



This is what it
looks like!
About 12 × 4
cm when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!

Make your own!

Black Garden Ant Felt Puzzle

A Giant Insect World puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again

You will need:

- Black felt or paper
- Scissors
- This instruction sheet and template
- The brown felt mat for soil habitat



How to build it

- 1 Trace each shape onto the black felt.
- 2 Cut out all 11 pieces carefully.
- 3 Lay the brown mat down — that's your soil!
- 4 Place head, thorax and abdomen in a line — leave a thin waist.
- 5 Add 6 legs from the thorax, three each side.
- 6 Add 2 bent antennae on the head. Done!

Did you know?



Ants live in huge colonies ruled by one big queen.

They "talk" with smells and little touches.

An ant can lift 50× its own body weight!

On warm days, winged ants fly off to start new nests.

Their body has 3 parts: head, thorax and abdomen (the big rear).

The pieces

Find these colours in felt or paper ■

Black

Using the template, cut out:

Head ×1 — black

Thorax ×1 — black

Abdomen ×1 — black (big rear)

Legs ×6 — black (bent in middle)

Antennae ×2 — black (bent)

That's 11 shapes in total!

Just one colour — the simplest kit in the set!



Finished!

Your ant is about 8 × 5 cm.

Take it apart and build it again!

Make a whole colony and line them up in a trail!

Collect the set:

Underground: woodlouse,
earthworm, ant



Make your own



Black Garden Ant
Lasius niger

A Giant Insect
World
felt puzzle
build it · take it apart
· build it again

Suitable for ages 5+

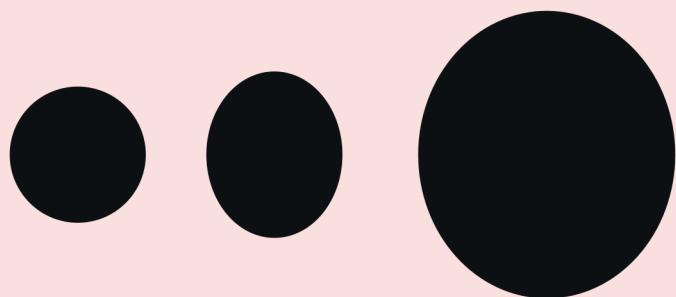


Collect the sets for
Meadow, Aquatic
and Underground
habitats

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ butterfly | ☐ bell spider |
| ☐ ladybird | ☐ woodlouse |
| ☐ grasshopper | ☐ earthworm |
| ☐ river skater | ☐ ant |
| ☐ dragonfly | |

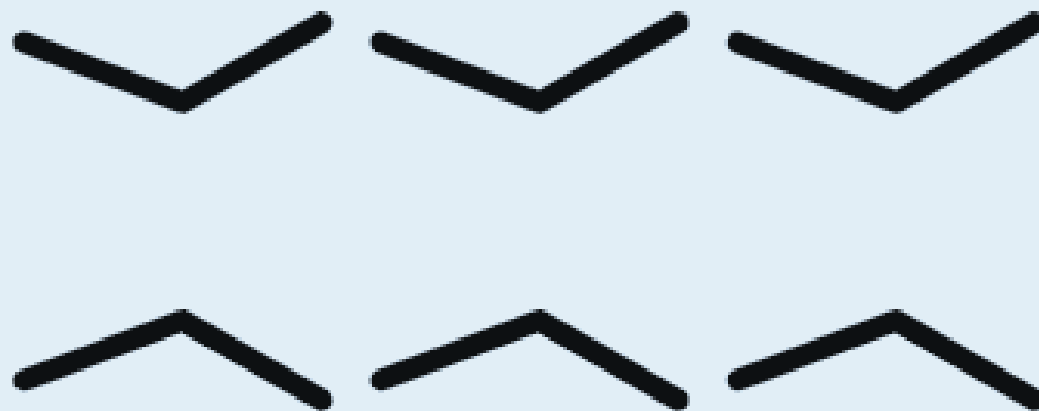
Photo © Alfie Felton, CC-BY
Logo © Giant Insect World

Body parts x3



Black felt · cut 1 head + 1 thorax + 1 abdomen
Leave thin gaps between them

Legs x6



Black felt · cut 6 legs
Bent in the middle, like a real ant leg

Antennae x2



Black felt · cut 2 antennae
Bent, with a little club on the end

Finished! ★



This is what it looks like!
About 8 × 5 cm when done

✂ Cut along the solid lines!